

News Bot Reflection

This is more of a solo assignment for me, as I really did my own thing throughout the assignment. I didn't really know what to do at first since I couldn't find my group. But since I was told I could do this solo, I got things going.

Unfortunately, this assignment has been delayed a lot due to my own procrastination and general confusion on how to start.

Thanks to the starter notebook template and my finally understanding how to get Kaggle data, I have a base from which to build the notebook.

For this project, I intended to use the News Category Dataset that was recommended to me. Though, as explained later, I also used the BBC News dataset provided to me by the template notebook.

It went alright for the first couple of cells, but then I encountered some errors that stalled the cell runs. Because of that, I have to retry running the notebook multiple times. And each time, I downloaded the new JSON file while overwriting the old one. However, I did it way too many times, and as a result, the cell that was currently running just stayed there for a while, and when I retried the run, it was just stuck in the first cell.

At that point I just felt stuck. Thankfully, I managed to restart the whole session. Though at this point, that served as a wake-up call, and I realized I had to change the way I was handling this

notebook. First off, I significantly decreased the article count from 2000 to 700 to improve performance. Next, instead of uploading more of the same .json file containing the same data, I declined the upload and continued through the process. That way, the cells could run faster overall, and I also constantly performed actions in the notebook, such as adding documentation from the template to prevent it from disconnecting again. Though it wasn't without its hurdles. One cell was taking so long to process that I decided to run the original template as well, just in case I wouldn't be able to submit my own in time.

After some time, I've completed the template notebook, and all I have to do now is create a repository for it, which wasn't that difficult. And after entering my information into the notebook, which ends with 'OsemudiaOgedengbe', I realized that the cell I was working on before was finally completed. And after a little hurdle regarding the placement of markdown text in a code cell, and the last markdown cell to add at the end, I managed to complete my notebook. I entered my information, this time putting 'FifehanmiOgedengbe' at the end of the notebook, and then added both to the GitHub repository. I then added a small README into the repository explaining the two notebooks, and that was it.

So, while my procrastination and programming issues delayed this project significantly, at least I managed to complete it all before the deadline hit, so I'm not complaining.